

ANIMAL CRECHE

Kolkata | WEST BENGAL



Big new bite

■ By Swagata Sen

In Tootoom's World, there's Munnabhai, there's Chhotu and there is Bozo who has been waiting for his parents to return from the US for the last three months. What sounds like a bizarre arena, is actually Ranjana Mukherjee's pet crèche in Kolkata. With modern working families often having to leave their pets unattended, it is Mukherjee who comes to their rescue, at Rs 250 a day. On a given day there are about half-a-

One woman's cure for loneliness becomes a thriving necessity for those who can't bear to let their pets live a dog's life

dozen dogs living in her home, on her bed and on her couch.

Mukherjee takes care of them as she would of little children. She asks their owners for diet charts and prepares their food accordingly.

She has now materialised into a champion of the canines, getting abandoned street puppies to find

homes and letting well-bred dogs find loving owners. Her only sad moment comes when her visitors leave. After the house is empty, she takes a rickshaw ride with Chhotu. That's the only time she leaves Tootoom's World, named after her beloved Spitz. "When Tootoom passed away in 2001, I felt my last support was taken away," says the lifelong singleton who was advised by the doctor to start the crèche. It's an idea Tootoom would have greeted with a woof of joy.



IN CANINE COMPANY:
Mukherjee and her dogs

SUVASHISH MULLICK

■ \$38.4 BILLION WAS SPENT
ON PETS IN THE US IN 2006

■ INDIAN PET FOOD
PRODUCTION IS ESTIMATED
TO BE 5,000 TONNE A YEAR

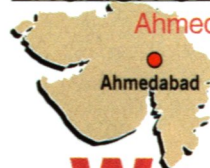
SHAILESH RAVAL



SHOWING THE
WAY: Dipti Shah

ENGLISH CLASSES

Ahmedabad | GUJARAT



Wording it right

English becomes a foot in the door for an increasingly ambitious Indian who thinks the world is a giant jobs bazaar

■ By Uday Mahurkar

It's a factory that turns raw material into finished products. The perfect human factory, where Dipti Shah, 56, teaches the English language, for those who want to learn it for pleasure or progress. Like Rushikesh Patel, 18, a Gujarati-medium college dropout, who dreams of becoming a male nurse in the US. Into his tenth week at the institute run by the husband-and-wife team of Dipti and Amit Shah, Patel is a changed man, a dynamo. He speaks English with confidence and recently gave the interview for a US visa, which will allow him to pursue his